

MS to stop supporting Live Mesh

Come February 13th, Microsoft will end support for its Live Mesh Sync Software attempting to push people to Skydrive instead

**Xolo A800 available online**

Lava Xolo A800 is available online in India for ₹11,999. It's a dual-SIM Android ICS phone powered by a 1GHz processor.

The latest buzz from the technology universe

A month of announcements, some that were great, and some that weren't

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It's been a busy month with several major launches and announcements being made across a variety of product categories: Valve's confirmation of a Steam Box in 2013, game publisher THQ announcing bankruptcy, Canon launching its entry level full-frame here and more.

Valve confirms Steam Box

Valve has confirmed that it will release a "Steam Box" video game console sometime in 2013. Speaking to Kotaku at the 2012 Video Game Awards, Gabe Newell confirmed that Valve is working on a living room-friendly PC that runs Steam. Newell says that reception



Steam Box prototype

for Steam's new, TV-oriented Big Picture mode has been "stronger than expected," and the company will now work to get Steam for Linux out of beta.

Beyond that, Gaben only gave us one other tidbit about

the Steam Box, stating that "our hardware will be a very controlled environment." In other words, the Steam Box will be a console, rather than some kind of PC that you can upgrade. Curiously, Newell also said that he expects other companies to sell living room PCs that will compete with next-gen consoles from Microsoft, Sony and Nintendo.

Valve in general, and Gabe in particular, seem to be on some kind of heroic mission to bring Steam to the mass market. Newell was one of the first critics of Windows 8, calling it "a catastrophe for everyone in the PC space." As far as we can tell, though, this hatred doesn't stem from the Metro interface; rather, Valve sees the Windows 8 Store as a direct threat to Steam. Valve is worried that the Windows Store will snuff out third-party digital distribution platforms.

What isn't clear, though, is how the Steam Box will actually combat the Windows Store. With Valve's focus on Steam for Linux, the current assumption is that the Steam Box will run Linux — but then the console won't be able to play more than a few dozen games. Valve is also working on a Linux port of its Source game engine, which will certainly help matters, but that isn't going to suddenly make *Skyrim* or *Mass Effect* compatible with Linux.

The other option, of course, is that the Steam Box will run

Windows 7. This would drive the cost of the console up, but it would mean that you could immediately play *Assassin's Creed III* on your TV, with your Valve gamepad.

Ultimately, though, the elephant in the room is the hardware itself. Newell very clearly tells Kotaku that the Steam Box will be a PC, rather than a custom piece of console hardware (such as the Xbox 360 or PS3). In all likelihood, this means the Steam Box will probably just be a small form factor (SFF) x86 PC — and as we know, high-powered SFFs are not cheap (\$600+). By pitching it as a living room PC with more capabilities than a conventional video game console, Valve has some leeway on the pricing — but not that much.

Canon EOS 6D launched in India

Canon has released the Canon EOS 6D, its lightest full-frame camera, into the Indian market. The camera is Canon's third full-frame variant, the first two being the Canon EOS 1Dx for the serious professional and the 5D Mark III designed to appease a larger audience.

The Canon EOS 6D features a magnesium and polycarbonate shell which sits on

an aluminium alloy chassis. Along with the 20 megapixel full-frame sensor, there is also the Digic 5+ image processor, which together allow the camera to range the ISO from ISO 100-25600 along with being able to shoot at 4.5 frames per second. There is also an 11-point auto focus system which provides a wider coverage of the frame, with the center focus point tuned to a sensitivity of -3EV, making the AF system in the 6D the most sensitive to low light.



Canon's lightest full frame EOS 6D

The 6D is also the first full frame camera to feature built-in Wi-Fi and GPS receiver that sits where the pop-up flash would. The downside to this is that the top plate of the 6D is plastic (in order to let the Wi-Fi and GPS signals go through), making the top not as solid as the rest of the body. The final change to the 6D comes with